One Disaster After Another!

Introduction

This lesson was taken from the Microsoft Bookshelf Teacher's Activity Guide. The Microsoft Bookshelf CD-ROM reference library combines multimedia resources, including text, audio clips, video clips, animation sequences, photographs, charts, illustrations, and Web links to create a compelling resource for students no matter what their learning style may be. The Teacher's Activity Guide provides students with exciting ways of becoming acquainted with Bookshelf as teachers integrate it into the classroom curriculum.

Objective

Use Bookshelf to complete the activity presented in the Activity Sheet.

Procedure

The assignment is given below as well as in the Activity Sheet. This activity can be utilized in fully equipped computer labs as well as in classrooms where there is only one computer serving as an information station. Students can execute this activity individually or in groups; suggestions for both modes are provided. Bookshelf makes the process of finding information interactive and engaging. Its format encourages investigation, experimentation, and browsing. Students working individually or in teams develop research skills and strategies as they locate the information they need.

For the Students (Activity Sheet)

It may seem as if life goes on pretty smoothly from one day to the next. But the world is a big place, so there is always something bad happening somewhere. Use Bookshelf to create your own Disasters Update.

Working Individually

Use Bookshelf to learn about different kinds of natural disasters, such as earthquakes, floods, hurricanes, and tornadoes. Create a presentation or paper about interesting facts about disasters that others might not know—for instance, how hard does the wind blow in a hurricane, and what causes a tornado?

Working in Groups

Create a television-like "special report" about disasters, using Bookshelf to research your information. The report can be in the form of telling people how to avoid danger during a disaster, or in describing how disasters occur. A group might also want to act as if they are reporting a disaster live—providing plenty of background information about what is happening.

Research Hints

Use the **Search All** tab to search for topics such as:

- Earthquake
- Flood control
- Hurricane
- Tornado
- Storm

From the **Books** menu, choose **Internet Directory** for a vast collection of World Wide Web sites that have information on disasters, including the Internet Disaster Information Network.

For articles, maps, or other media pertaining to this topic, look up the following in Encarta® Encyclopedia:
Natural Disaster

The following items in the Encarta® World English Dictionary® contain information about this topic:
Sources suggested in the lesson

For additional online information and media, view the following Encarta articles:
Natural Disaster